

Attack or Fault in Real Incidents: A Structured Case Study of Cause Ambiguity at Trading Infrastructure

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Abstract

[Abstract to be drafted once the case table exists.]

Keywords incident response; cause attribution; trading infrastructure; case study; cyberattack; system failure

1. Introduction

2. Background and related work

3. Research questions and the assumptions they examine

4. Method

- 4.1. Design and unit of analysis
- 4.2. Corpus and sources
- 4.3. Search and screening
- 4.4. Coding, agreement and reconciliation
- 4.5. Analysis

5. The cases

6. Cross-case results

- 6.1. RQ1: Was the cause ambiguous while operators acted?
- 6.2. RQ2: Did market-facing observables settle the cause?
- 6.3. RQ3: What did operators do while the cause was unknown?
- 6.4. RQ4: Is strategic imitation documented?
- 6.5. Where the evidence of ambiguity lives
- 6.6. Sensitivity and disconfirming cases

7. Discussion

8. Limitations and threats to validity

9. Conclusion

Data availability

[Data availability statement to be written.]

Funding

[To be supplied.]

Conflict of interest

[To be supplied.]

Use of AI tools

[To be supplied.]